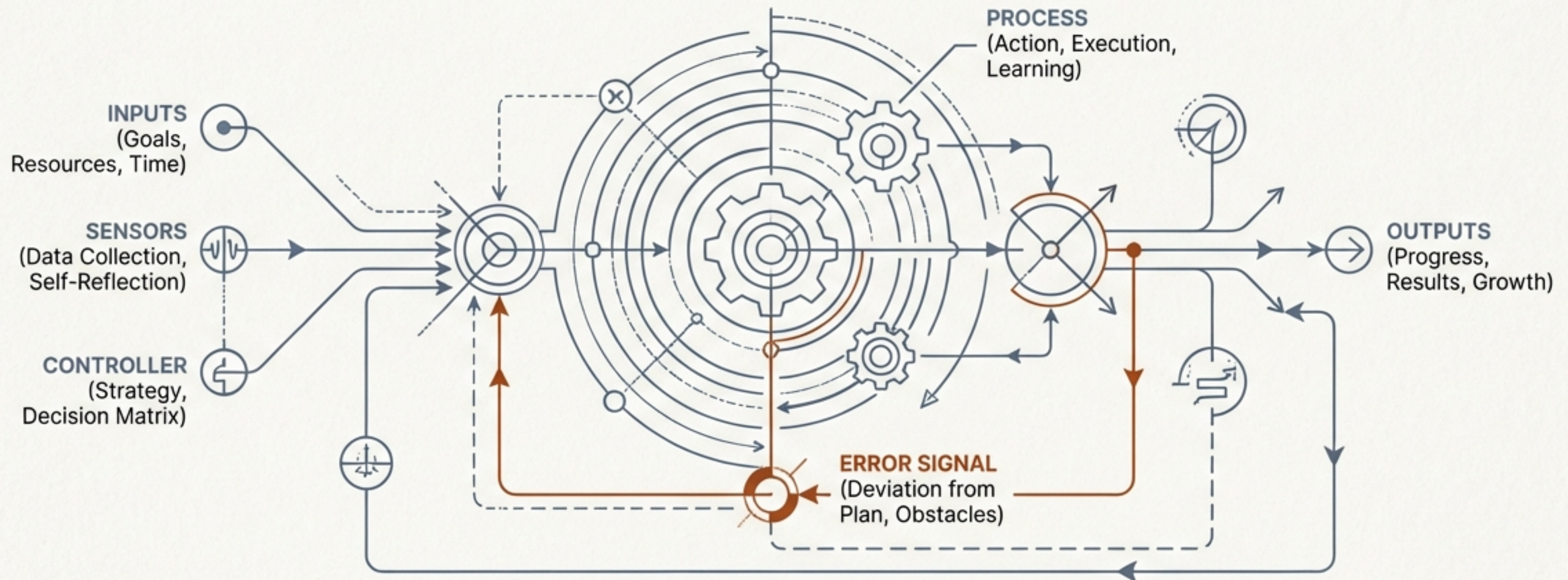


Kaizen v2: A Control System for Strategic Life Design

Replacing wishful thinking with engineering principles for verifiable progress.



Most systems reward activity, not progress.



Activity

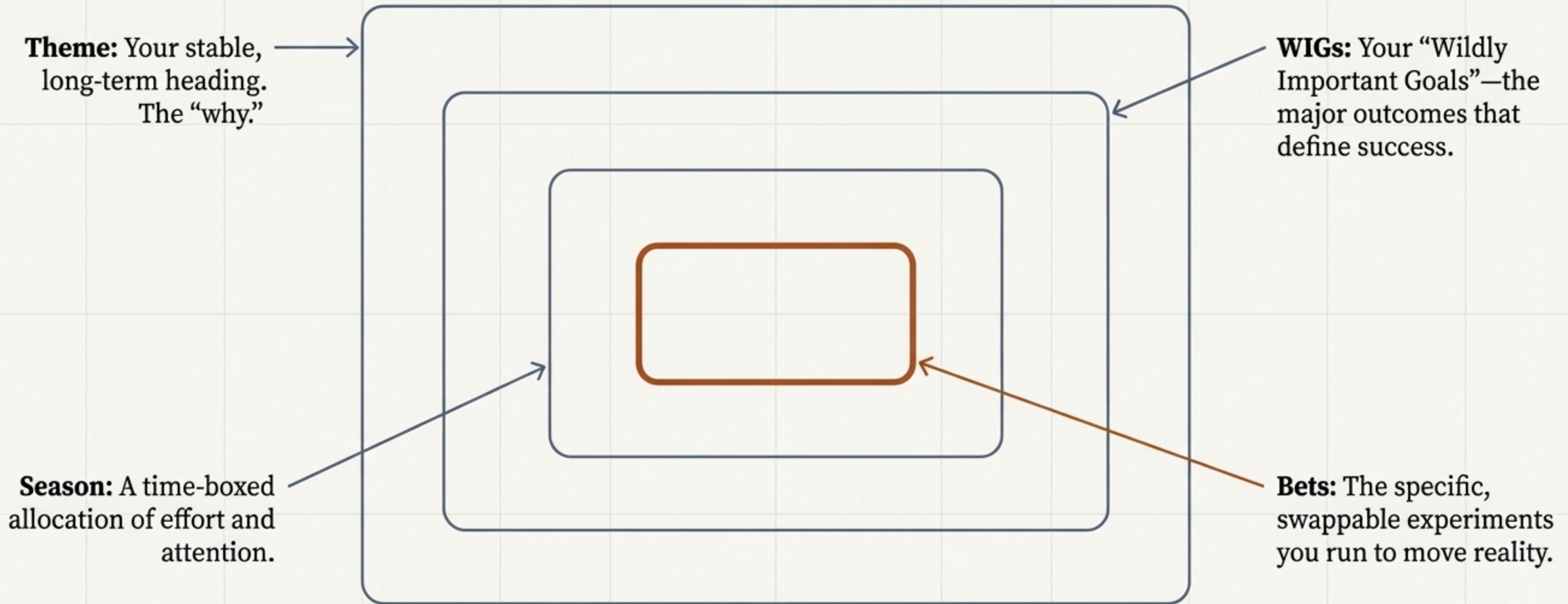


Progress

We mistake “feeling productive” for producing verifiable evidence of change. This leads to optimizing for metrics that don't matter, a trap famously described by Goodhart's Law: “When a measure becomes a target, it ceases to be a good measure.”

We need an operating system designed for honesty, adaptability, and a clear connection between our actions and our most important outcomes.

The Kaizen v2 Architecture: A Nested Hierarchy of Intent



This is a control system: themes are your heading, WIGs are your destination markers, seasons are your allocation of thrust, and bets are the actuators you use to create change.

Setting the Strategic Compass: Themes & WIGs



Themes

A **stable, long-term** direction.

- love/presence
- health/self-mastery
- wisdom/humility
- AI/startups

WIGs (Wildly Important Goals)

A small set of **high-priority outcomes** you refuse to drown in the whirlwind of daily life.

WIGs are not daily operating units. They are the **scoreboard** that tells you “why this season matters.”

Where Strategy Meets Reality: Seasons & Bets

The Season

A fixed window of work (e.g., 11 weeks) with a pre-defined budget of time and energy per theme.

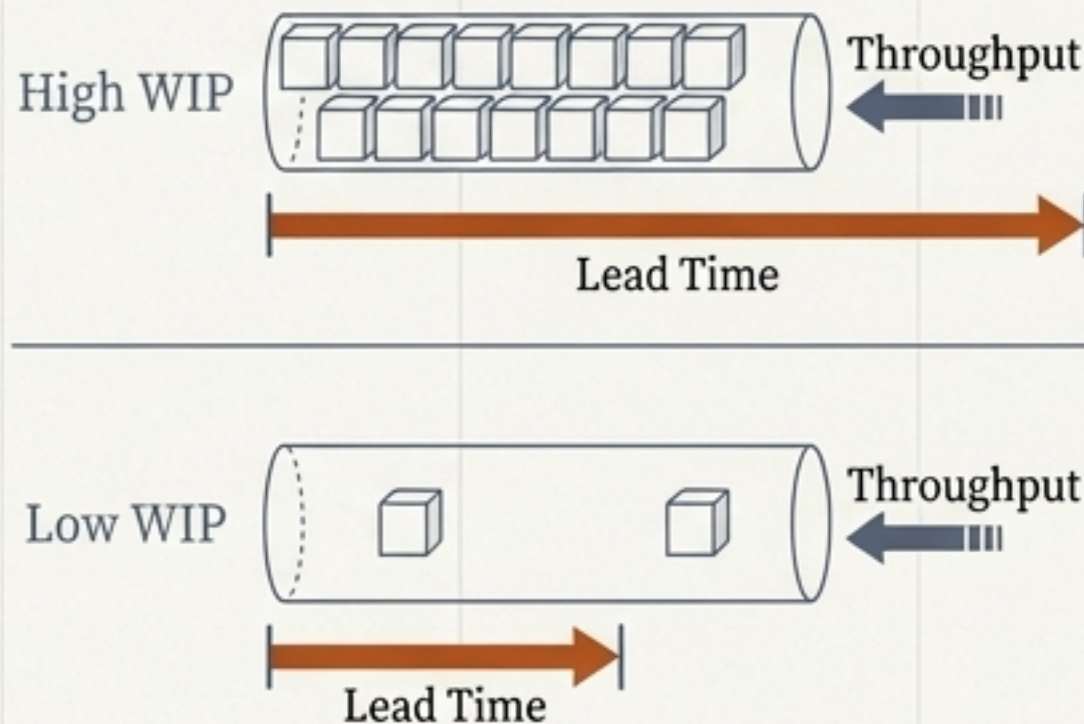
$$H_t = a_t \cdot H$$

(Theme Budget = Theme Allocation × Total Season Hours)

The Portfolio of Bets

Keep active bets per theme to 1 (or 2, max). 'Small' is not a vibe; it's physics.

The Rationale (Little's Law)



$$\text{WIP} = \text{Throughput} \times \text{Lead Time}$$

Because your throughput is bounded, increasing Work-in-Progress (WIP) directly forces up the time it takes to complete anything. Limiting WIP makes progress predictable.

Anatomy of a Bet: A Falsifiable Hypothesis, Not a To-Do List

Tasks (Inputs): What you will actually do (your exposure).

Veto / Guardrails (Constraints):
Tripwires that automatically force a re-evaluation (e.g., 'sleep fell below 6 hours for 3 consecutive nights').

BET CONTRACT

Tasks

- _____
- _____
- _____
- _____

Anchor Outcomes

☐	_____	1
☐	_____	1
☐	_____	1
☐	_____	0
☐	_____	0

Expected Lag
/ _____ time

Veto / Guardrails

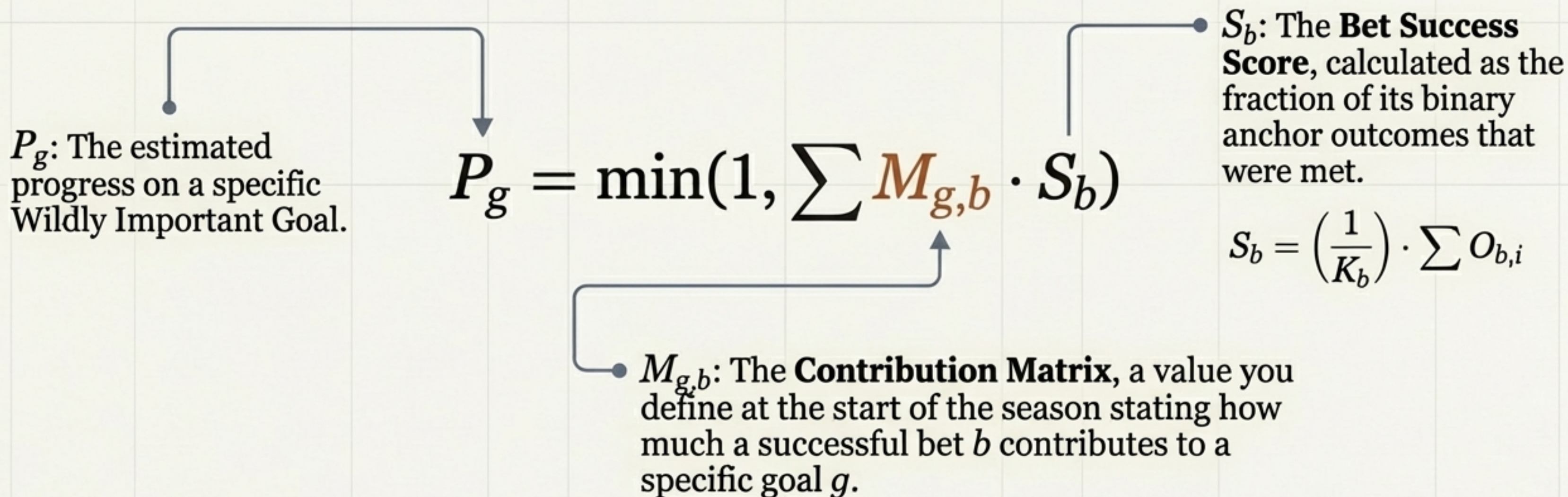
- ! _____
- ! _____

Anchor Outcomes (Outputs):
2-4 binary, reality-graded results. Was the outcome achieved (1) or not (0)? This removes ambiguity.

Expected Lag (Timing):
How long before you can fairly judge the results.

The system uses **operational definitions** to turn abstract goals ('be more present') into observable, testable indicators, just like in scientific research.

The Engine Part 1: How do we know our bets are advancing our goals?



Every bet must 'pay rent' by contributing to at least one WIG.
This enforces portfolio coherence and eliminates random projects.

The Engine Part 2: A 'Condition Dashboard' That Models Reality

Instead of a cumulative score (XP) that never goes down, we track a decayed recent sum. Relapse and neglect show up automatically.

$$C_t = 100 \cdot \frac{\sum E_t(d-k) \cdot e^{-k/\tau_t}}{\sum T_t(d-k) \cdot e^{-k/\tau_t}}$$

C_t : Your "Condition" **score for a theme**.
100 means you're matching your recent plan.

$E_t(d-k)$: Your actual exposure (e.g., hours) on a given day.

The "**Forgetting Curve**."
This term ensures recent efforts matter more than distant ones.

τ_t : The **Decay Constant**.
A smaller τ means faster decay (e.g., for fitness) while a larger τ works for things like trust.

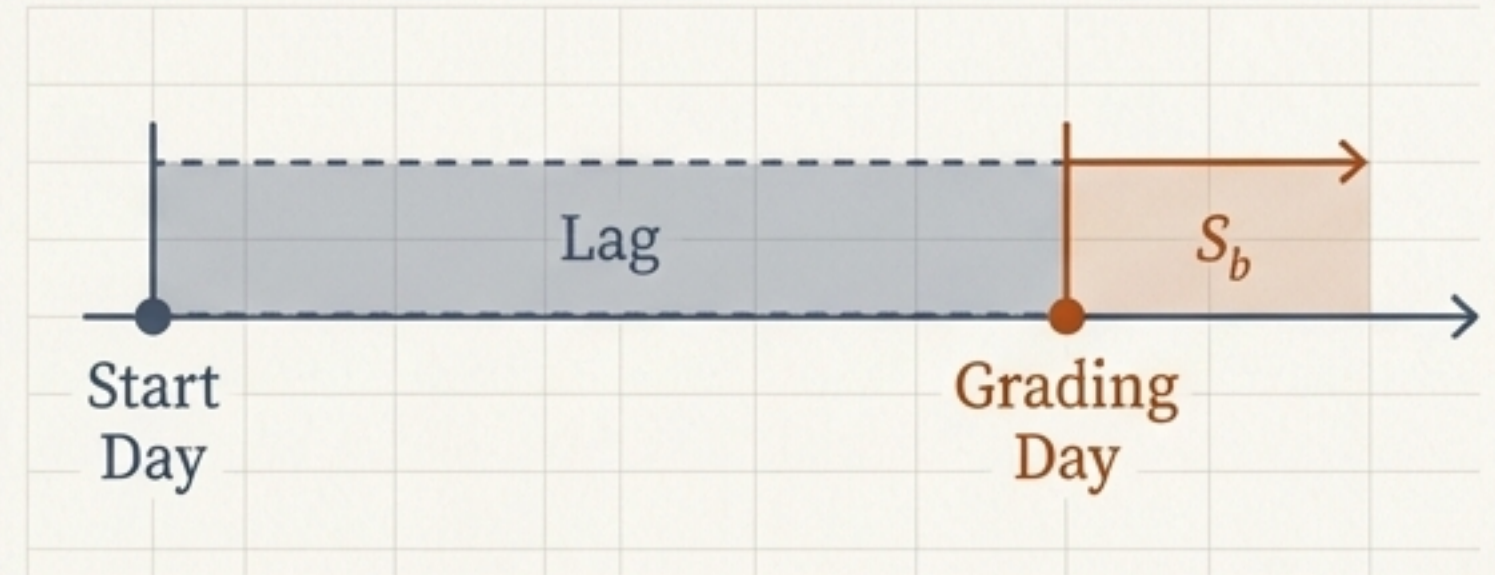
This isn't a grade. It's a smooth, honest signal of whether you are currently feeding a theme.

The Engine Part 3: Enforcing Honesty with Lag and Guardrails

The Patience Protocol (Expected Lag)

A bet's success score S_b is not graded until $\text{day} \geq \text{start_day} + \text{Lag}$.

This prevents you from declaring success prematurely based on feeling, or declaring failure after one bad week. It forces you to honor the experiment's design.

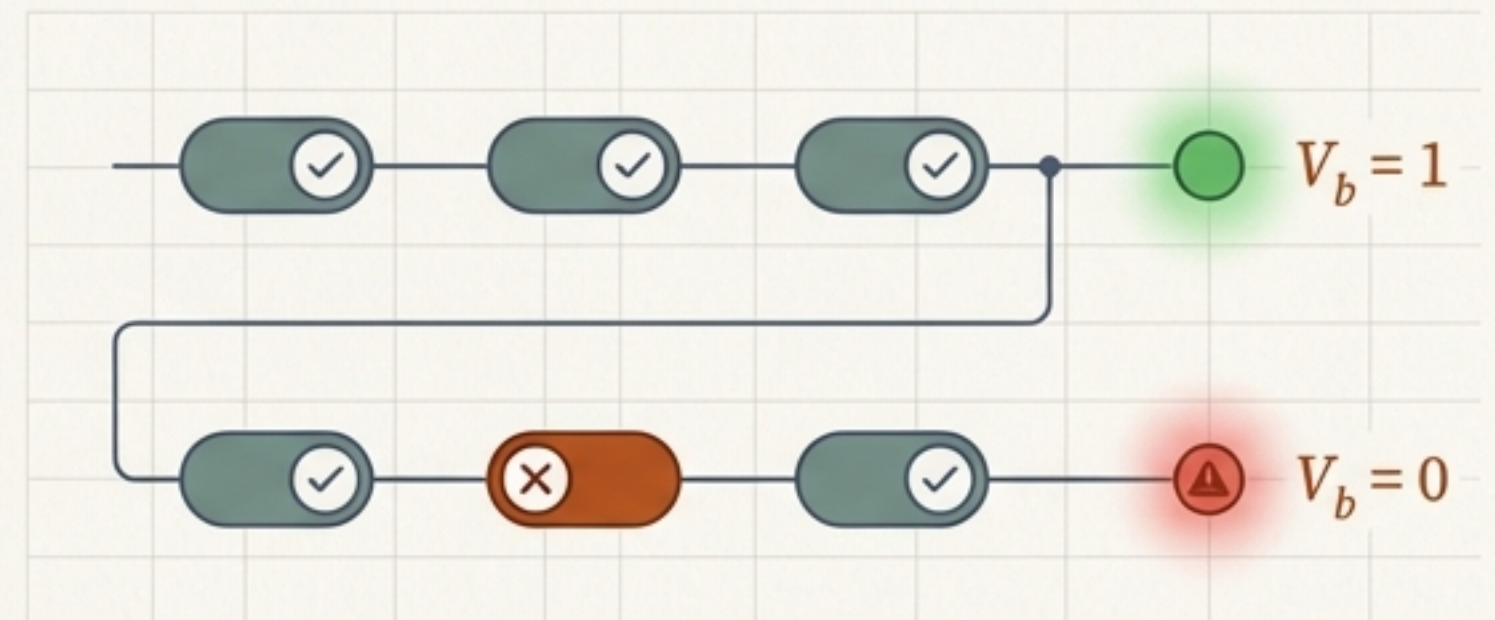


The Safety Protocol (Guardrails)

A bet's viability $V_b(d)$ is a product of all its guardrail booleans ($G_{b,j}$).

$$V_b(d) = \prod_j G_{b,j}(d)$$

If any guardrail is tripped (V_b becomes 0), you don't negotiate. The system forces a response: reduce scope, deload, or pause the bet.



These rules protect you from your own biases and keep ambition from breaking your well-being.

The Engine Part 4: Is Your Effort Pointing in the Right Direction?

Are you moving fast, but off heading? We measure this with Drift.

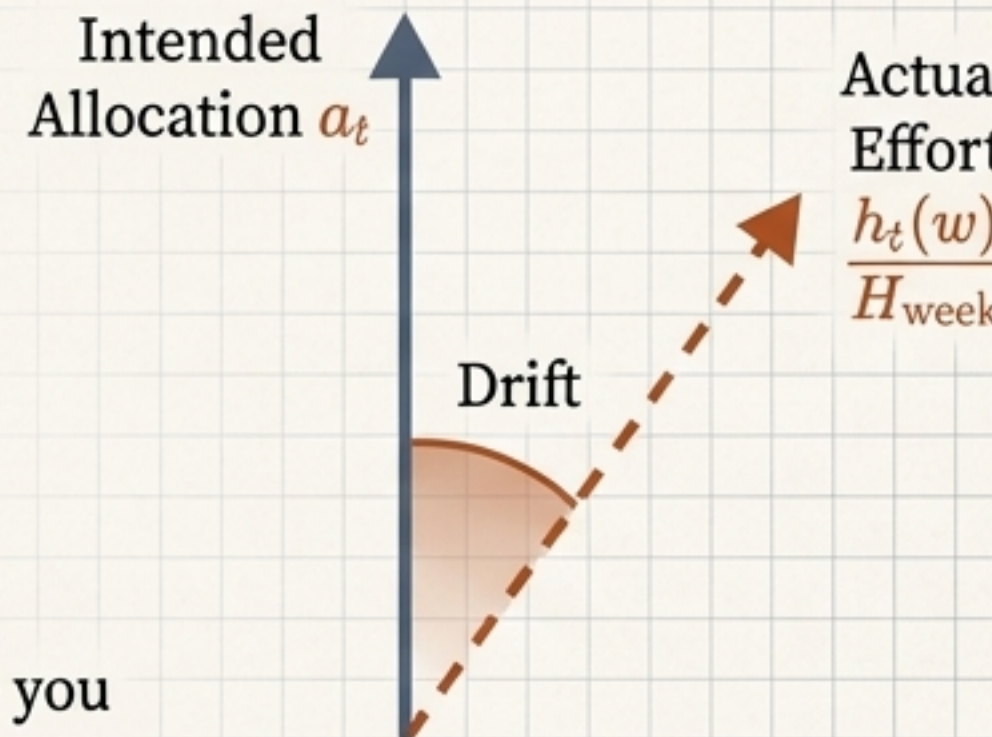
Weekly Drift percentage from your spot this week.

$$\text{Drift}(w) = \sum_t \left| \frac{h_t(w)}{H_{\text{week}}} - a_t \right|$$

Drift(w): Your total deviation from your plan this week.

$\frac{h_t(w)}{H_{\text{week}}}$: The actual percentage of time you spent on theme t .

a_t : The target percentage of time you allocated to theme t .



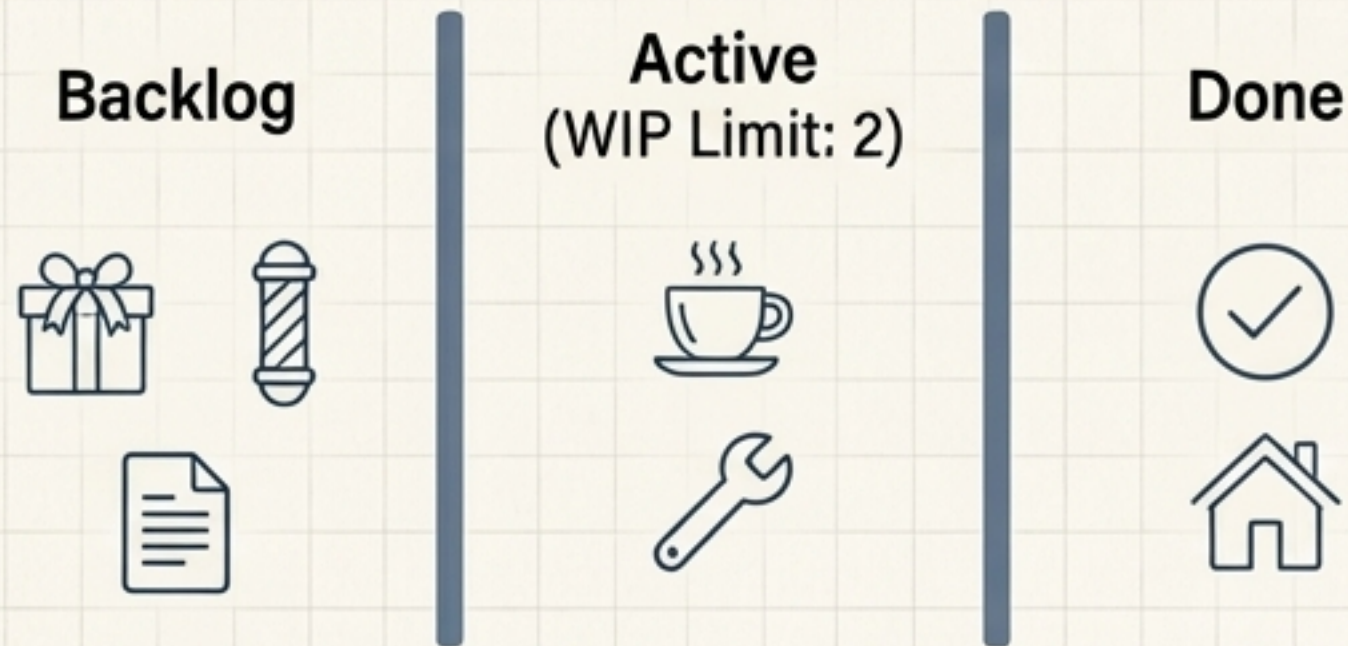
High drift is not a moral failure; it is information. It prompts a conscious decision: do you correct your course next week, or do you update your map because the bets themselves are misaligned?

Managing Real-World Friction: The “Chores Problem”

Forcing every minor task (barber, gifts, admin) into a theme bet creates bureaucracy. Ignoring them creates background chaos that derails your season.

Solution 1: The “Ops Lane”

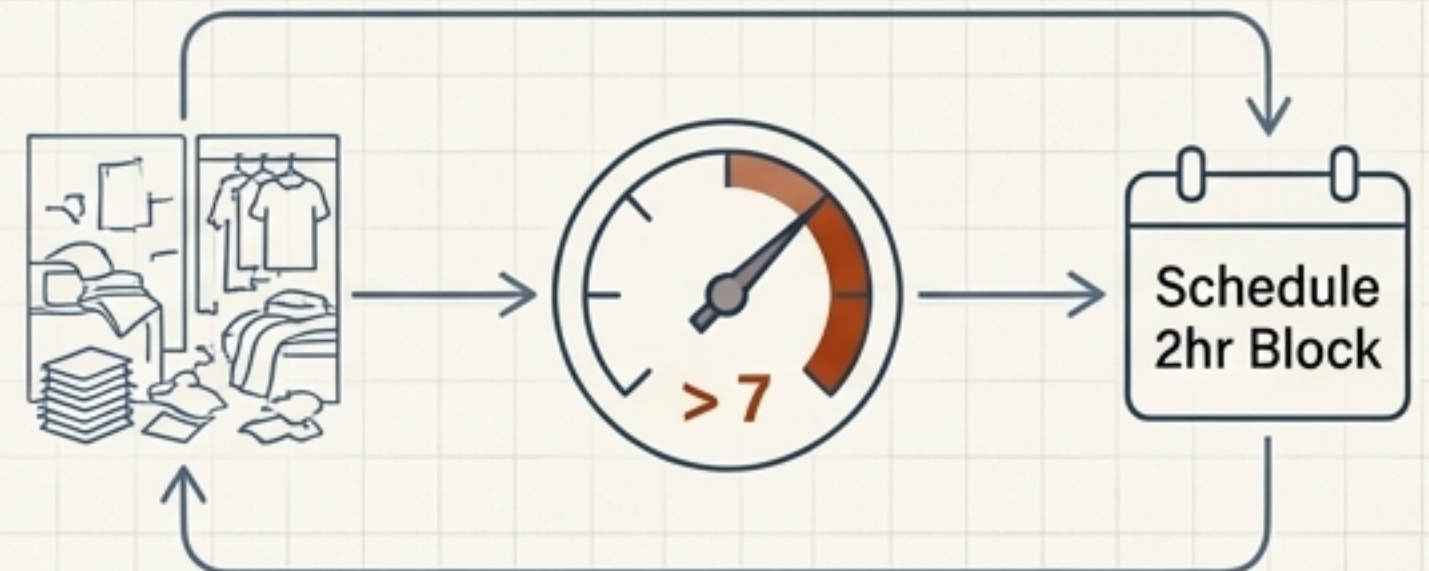
A dedicated, non-theme buffer of time (e.g., 5–10% of your week). Chores are treated as tickets with a strict WIP limit. This prevents admin overload and restores a “finish-what-you-start” flow, per Little’s Law.



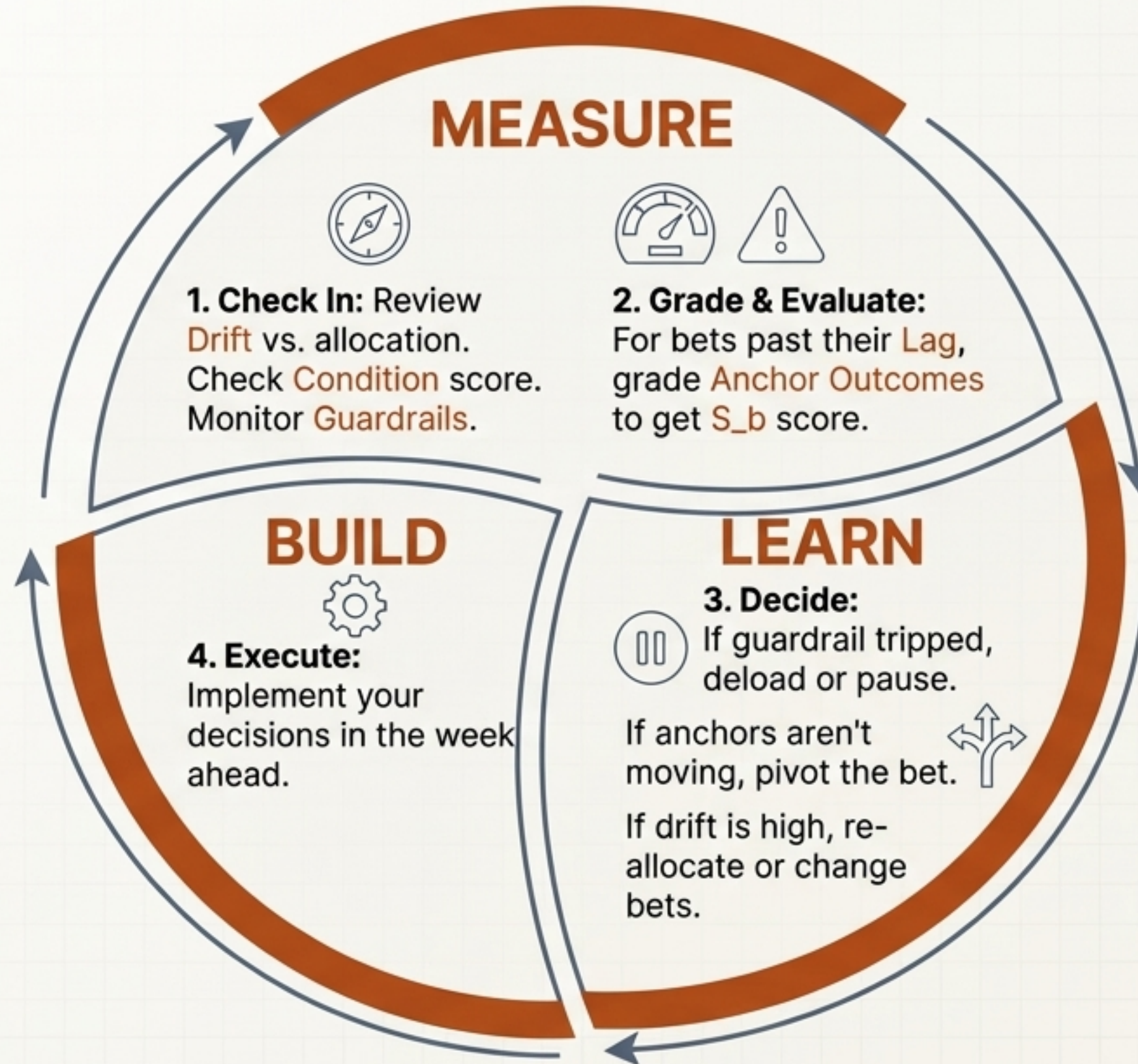
Solution 2: “Maintenance Taxes”

Recurring chores become triggers attached to guardrails, not aspirational goals.

IF home clutter score > 7, **THEN** schedule a 2-hour storage block in the Ops Lane this week.



Closing the Loop: The Weekly Review



A Concrete Example: Season Portfolio for 'Love & Presence'

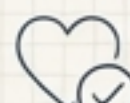
Context

Theme Allocation: $a_t = 25\%$ Season Hours: $H = 1000$ Theme Budget: $H_t = 250$ hours

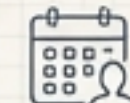
WIG 1 Feel deeply connected and present during family time.

Bet Details

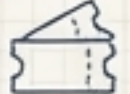
Bet 1 (Primary)

-  **Tasks:** Device-free dinners 5x/week; one dedicated 3-hour family outing on weekends.
-  **Lag:** 4 weeks.
-  **Anchors:** (1) Partner reports feeling more connection (binary survey).
(2) I feel present and not distracted >80% of the time (self-report).
-  **Guardrail:** No checking work email after 7 PM on weekdays.

Bet 2 (Maintenance)

-  **Task:** Schedule one date night every two weeks.

Ops Lane Integration

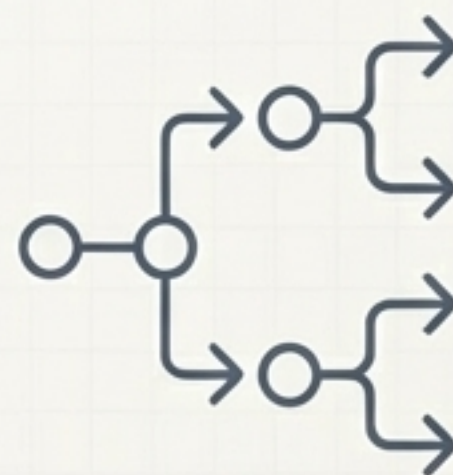
 Tickets for 'Buy anniversary gift' and 'Plan summer vacation details' live here, not as bets. 

The Shift: From Productivity Theater to Verifiable Progress



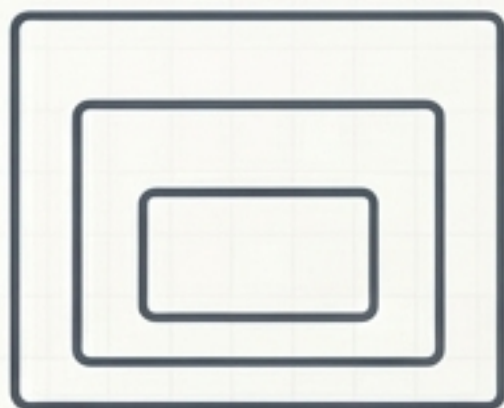
Built-in Honesty

The math and rules prevent self-deception and premature judgments.



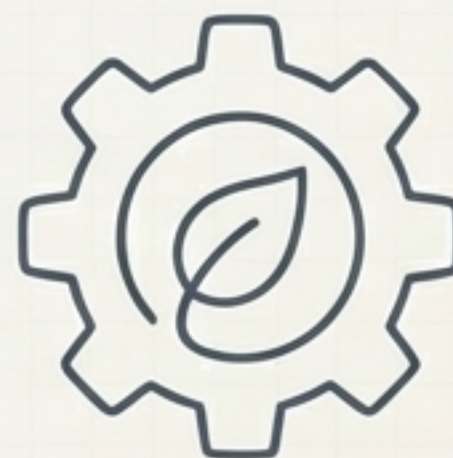
Systematic Adaptability

Bets are experiments. The weekly loop makes ‘pivot or persevere’ a data-driven decision, not an emotional one.



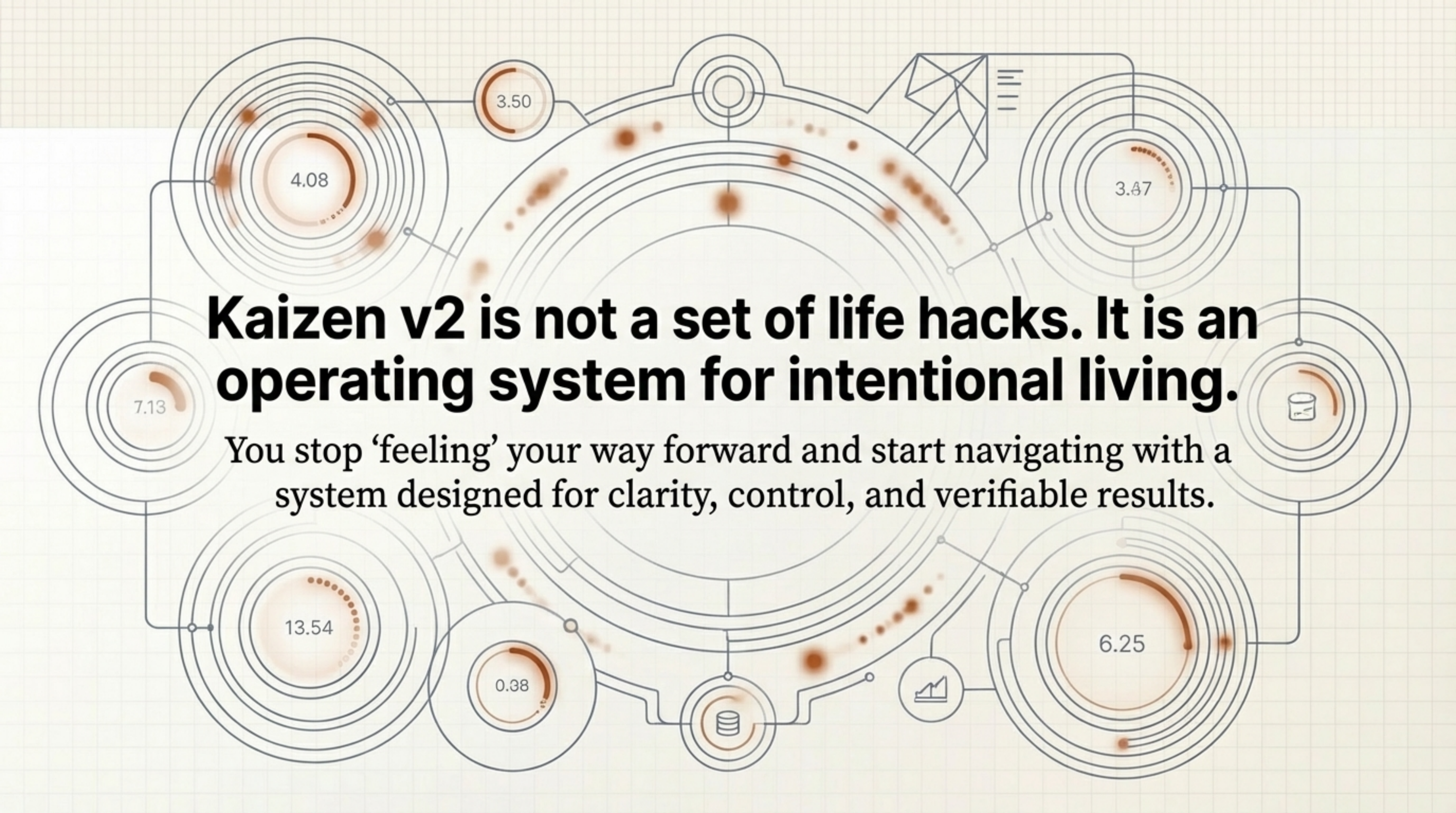
Strategic Coherence

The hierarchy ensures that daily actions (‘Bets’) are always in service of your most important goals (‘WIGs’).



Designed Sustainability

Guardrails, the Ops Lane, and Maintenance Taxes prevent burnout and manage the chaos of real life.



Kaizen v2 is not a set of life hacks. It is an operating system for intentional living.

You stop 'feeling' your way forward and start navigating with a system designed for clarity, control, and verifiable results.